



OF BOOZE & WITCHERY

Witcher 3's Blood and Wine packs more action in an expansion pack than most full-priced games

By Videep “fr4k” Vijay Kumar



One thing's for certain: we're not going to be seeing much more of Geralt after Blood and Wine, and arguably, that's the most disappointing thing about The Witcher 3's second and final expansion. This is CD Projekt Red saying goodbye to the monster slayer who has stolen many hearts and minds (literally, on occasion).

Blood and Wine is not necessarily a game changer as it is a relative high point in the execution of The Witcher formula. The combination of powerful storytelling,

immersive world of Toussaint, emergent systems and consistent evolution of gameplay over the years reaches its peak in the latest expansion, while some minor annoyances do make appearances. But in the end, series fans have several dozen hours of Witcher content to sink their teeth into, and for those of you who haven't played The Witcher 3 at all, this is the perfect time to grab the game and its expansion to experience the complete story in one shot.

The masquerade

If you've played the base game before, you will be able to carry forward your

character into Blood and Wine, but a minimum level of 35 is recommended to kick off your journey. Like the game's previous expansion, you will be able to create fresh character at level 35 as well—a good option if you feel you need to re-spec all your stats and abilities. Your journey then begins in the noticeboard at Mulbrydale—a quick chat and skirmish will ensue, after which you are taken to the wonderful, charming new area of Toussaint, a picturesque, high-fantasy take on the south of France, untouched by war.

It doesn't take long before you're thrust into action once again, and it's this sort of pacing that sets Blood and

